

AdvocateAuroraHealth

Title: AAH HIT Incident Notification and Incident Command Activation		Document Number: 63107
Document Type: ☒ Policy ☒ Procedure ☐ Guideline ☐ Other		Last Review/Revision Date: 05/03/2021
Content Applies to Patient Care: (Select all that apply) ☐ Adults ☐ Pediatrics (Under 18)	Content Applies to: (Select One) ☐ Clinical ☒ Administrative	Next Review Date: 05/03/2024
		Effective Date: 05/03/2021
Scope: ☒ AAH System ☐ ACH ☐ AAH IL Only ☐ AAH WI Only ☐ Site Only (Location Name): ☐ Department Only (Department Name):		

I. PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to establish a Health Informatics and Technology (HIT) Incident Command framework that provides a coordinated response to HIT unplanned major incidents.

II. SCOPE

This policy and procedure applies to Advocate Aurora Health, Inc. and any entity or facility owned or controlled by Advocate Aurora Health (AAH).

III. DEFINITIONS/ABBREVIATIONS

DCO – Data Center Operations

DR/BCP – Disaster Recovery/Business Continuity Plan

HIT - Health Informatics and Technology

IMT – Incident Management Team

Major Incident Priority – priority is assigned based on criticality of event (High=1, Medium=2, Low=3)

QMOC - Quality Management Oversight Committee

Service Owner – Leader who supports an application/service

TIR - Technical Incident Report

IV. POLICY

Detection of an HIT unplanned Priority 1 major incident will necessitate the activation of the HIT Incident Command Team to render support and manage the major incident to resolution.

The HIT Incident Command Team enables effective and efficient incident management between HIT leaders and team members that requires coordinating efforts with teams across AAH affected by the incident. The goal is to successfully manage the incident, minimize impact, and return the entity and administrative support centers to normal operational status.

This policy and procedure may be used in conjunction with the System Incident Notification and Incident Command Activation Policy, the Advocate Aurora Business Continuity Plan, Health Informatics and Technology Disaster Recovery Plan and/or the Cybersecurity Incident Response Plan.

V. PROCEDURE

A. Detection of HIT Unplanned Major Incident:

1. The HIT Data Center Operations (DCO) team is notified by the Service Desk, via infrastructure monitoring, or directly from a service owner when a potential major incident has occurred. Refer to the HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 1 - Detection).
 - a) The DCO team triages the potential major incident and determines:
 - (1) The type of incident/occurrence
 - (2) When the incident/occurrence began
 - (3) The impact on technology and/or systems to AAH entity or facility
 - 4) If the incident qualifies as a major incident based on scope and impact
 - b) The DCO team and service owner determine the priority of the major incident (1,2 or 3) referencing the Major Incident Priority Matrix.
 - c) If a Priority 1 major incident, the DCO team contacts the on call HIT senior leader of affected service area who determines activation of HIT Incident Management Team (IMT).
 - d) The DCO team will notify the HIT Incident Management Team of Incident Command activation (in person or virtual) via a message notification system.
 - e) If a Priority 2 or 3 major incident, DCO team facilitates and communicates, via a message notification system, through restoration.

B. Activation of HIT Incident Management Team:

1. The HIT Incident Management Team (IMT), comprised of HIT senior leaders and technical/application HIT leaders, will be convened in person or virtually. An HIT Incident Commander will be determined based on the nature of the major incident and the availability of staff. The HIT Incident Commander must be present at the HIT Incident Management Center or on the HIT Incident Management call. Refer to the HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 2 – IMT Setup).

2. The HIT Incident Commander manages incident response, directs activities, and appoints additional command staff based on the scope and impact of the major incident:
 - a) Incident Scribe
 - b) IT Systems Unit Leader
 - c) IT Applications Unit Leader
 - d) Public Information Officer
 - e) Client Impact Liaison Officer
 - f) Security Liaison Officer
 - e) DR/BCP Liaison Officer
3. The DR/BCP Liaison Officer contacts the Emergency Preparedness Director or designee about the major incident. Refer to HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 5 -System Incident Management) and System Incident Notification and Incident Command Activation (doc. # 2522)
4. If there is a security element to the major incident, the Security Liaison Officer contacts the HIT Security Team. Refer to HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 4 – Security Process) and Cybersecurity Incident Response.

C. HIT Incident Management Team Incident Facilitation:

1. The HIT Incident Management Team will develop and communicate a system-wide plan of action as needed, and re-assess ongoing situation status. Refer to the HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 3 – Incident Facilitation).
2. The IT Systems and Applications Unit Leaders ensure information technology, computers, networks, and applications remain operational, and are restored or augmented as needed to maintain the continuity of essential business operations. Regular updates are provided to the HIT Incident Command Team of restoration efforts.
3. The Public Information Officer coordinates the exchange and flow of information internally and works directly with Public Affairs and Marketing for external communications, if needed. Communication will be provided to appropriate leadership utilizing a message notification system. The frequency of communication will be determined by the HIT Incident Management Team according to the nature of the major incident. Refer to the HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 6 – Extended Communication).

4. The Client Impact Liaison Officer is the primary contact for internal department/service lines or executives & high-level stakeholders providing feedback to the HIT Incident Management Team.
5. The HIT Incident Management Team monitors the major incident and declares a DR/BCP event, if required. The DR/BCP Liaison activates the DR/BCP plans. Refer to Technology Disaster Recovery Plan and Business Continuity Plan.

D. Termination Procedure

1. When a resolution is implemented and the affected sites/system entities verify impaired services are operational, the HIT Incident Commander determines that the incident has concluded. The HIT Incident Commander will announce the termination of the HIT Incident Management Team. The termination will be communicated to appropriate leadership via a message notification system.
2. A Technical Incident Report (TIR) will be completed by the service owner of the major incident which will include incident detail, timeline, resolution, and root cause. The TIR will be shared with the HIT Incident Command Team.
3. In the weekly HIT Major Incident meeting, the service owner reports on the major incident including business impact and root cause. If the root cause is not immediately known and/or prevention strategies need to be identified and implemented, a Problem Ticket will be opened in the Service Management system to track progress to completion. Details of this meeting are reported to the HIT Executive Leadership Team and to the System Safety Huddle.
4. A debriefing will be conducted by the HIT Incident Command Steering Committee to identify opportunities for future improvement after the completion of each HIT Incident Command activation. An After-Action Report will be completed, reviewed by the HIT Executive Leadership Team, and revisions made as directed. The Final After-Action Report will be reported through the Advocate Aurora Support Center Quality Management Oversight Committee (QMOC). Refer to HIT Incident Command Flowchart (Phase 7 – Post Incident Review).

VI. CROSS REFERENCES

- A. AAH Business Continuity Plan
- B. AAH Cybersecurity Incident Response
- C. AAH System Incident Notification and Incident Command Activation
- D. AAH Health Informatics & Technology Disaster Recovery Plan

VII. RESOURCES AND REFERENCES

- A. (Center for Internet Security) CIS Control 19 – Incident Response and Management (19.1-19.8)
- B. NIST 800-53: IR 1, IR 6, IR 8, SI 5
- C. PCI DSS 12.1, 12.10.1, 12.10.3, 12.10.4

VIII. ATTACHMENTS

- A. HIT After-Action Report
- B. HIT Incident Command Flowchart
- C. HIT Technical Incident Report